

Results outline corintreespotters

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Research questions

1. Does tree growth increase with longer growing seasons?
2. Did an earlier start and later end of season increase growth?
3. Does tree growth increase with longer growing seasons and is it consistent across species?
4. How did growth change across years, and how did it relate to climate?

Results

1. Summary basic information
 - (a) Coringtreespotters includes eleven with leaf phenology data spanning nine years (2016 to 2024) for a total of 326 leafout and 289 colored leaves observations, yielding 278 complete growing seasons (GS) for 49 individuals.
 - (b) GSL ranged from 77 days (*A. flava* in 2018) to 194 days (*A. saccharum* in 2021)
 - (c) GS thermal sum ranged from 1048.8 GDD (*A. flava* in 2020) to 2634.7 GDD, (*T. americana* in 2016)
 - (d) The earliest leafout day of year was 08-Apr (2021) and the latest, 15-May (2021). The earliest colored leaves day of year was 15-Jul (2021) and the latest, 06-Nov (2021)
 - (e) Mean summer temperatures ranged from 21.53°C, in 2017 to 23.07°C, in 2020 and PDSI values ranged from -4.04, in 2016 to 4.02, in 2019
2. Does tree growth increase with longer growing seasons?
 - (a) No clear trend of growing season length effect across our eleven species and season predictors.
 - (b) Longer thermal season increased growth *weakly for *A. saccharum* ($\beta = 0.09$, UI_{90} [-0.02, 0.2]), *B. nigra* ($\beta = 0.08$, UI_{90} [-0.01, 0.16]), *C. glabra* ($\beta = 0.05$, UI_{90} [-0.07, 0.17]), *Q. rubra* ($\beta = 0.09$, UI_{90} [-0.09, 0.26]), and decreased for *B. alleghaniensis* ($\beta = -0.22$, UI_{90} [-0.35, -0.1])) (Figure 1a and e) (Table ??).
 - (c) Of the four species that grew more with longer thermal season all, only two also grew more with longer calendar season (*B. nigra*: $\beta = 0.03$, UI_{90} [-0.02, 0.07], *C. glabra*: $\beta = 0.03$, UI_{90} [-0.03, 0.08]), and *T. americana* growth decreased ($\beta = -0.02$, UI_{90} [-0.05, 0.01]), unlike its response to the thermal season.
 - (d) *B. alleghaniensis* trended in the same direction, but showed a weaker response than the thermal season ($\beta = -0.05$, UI_{90} [-0.12, 0.02]) (Figure 1b and f) (Table ??). (Figure ??b).
3. Did a later start and end of season increase growth?
 - (a) A later start of season increased growth for *T. americana* ($\beta = 0.14$, UI_{90} [0.02, 0.27]), but *A. saccharum*: $\beta = 0.07$, UI_{90} [-0.02, 0.17], *B. nigra*: $\beta = 0.03$, UI_{90} [-0.1, 0.16], *C. glabra*: $\beta = 0.07$, UI_{90} [-0.07, 0.22], *C. ovata*: $\beta = 0.1$, UI_{90} [-0.04, 0.23], *P. deltoides*: $\beta = 0.06$, UI_{90} [-0.09, 0.21], *Q. rubra*: $\beta = 0.08$, UI_{90} [-0.1, 0.26] trended in the same direction, and *B. alleghaniensis* ($\beta = -0.07$, UI_{90} [-0.21, 0.07]) trended in the opposite direction (Figure 1c and g) (Table ??).
 - (b) A later end of season decreased growth for *B. alleghaniensis* ($\beta = -0.08$, UI_{90} [-0.16, -0.01]), but *T. americana* ($\beta = -0.01$, UI_{90} [-0.04, 0.02]) trended towards the same direction and *A. saccharum* ($\beta = 0.03$, UI_{90} [-0.03, 0.08], *B. nigra* ($\beta = 0.03$, UI_{90} [-0.02, 0.08]), and *C. glabra*: $\beta = 0.03$, UI_{90} [-0.02, 0.09] trended towards an increase in growth. (Figure 1d and h) (Table ??).

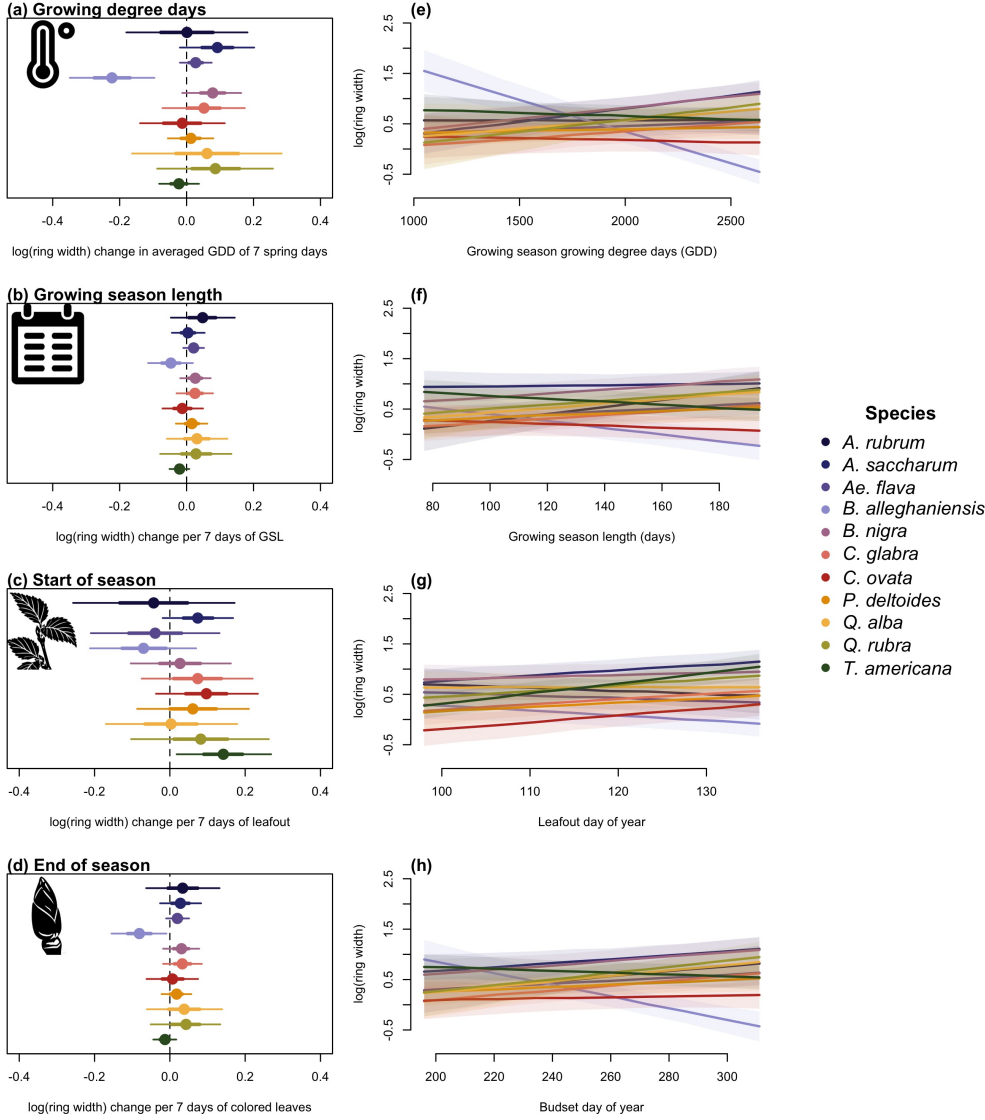


Figure 1: Model slope estimates representing ring width change as a function of four different predictors across four species. GDD represent the accumulated growing degree days between leafout and coloredLeaves and the models estimates shows ring width change per 7 average spring days GDD (176.87) (a). GSL is the number of days between leafout and coloredLeaves (b). SOS represent the start of season, which is leafout (c) and EOS, the end of season through coloredLeaves (d). All predictors were fit using the same model and number of observations, with only the independent variable changing. The dots represent the mean of each species and the lines, the 50% and 90% uncertainty intervals (UI).

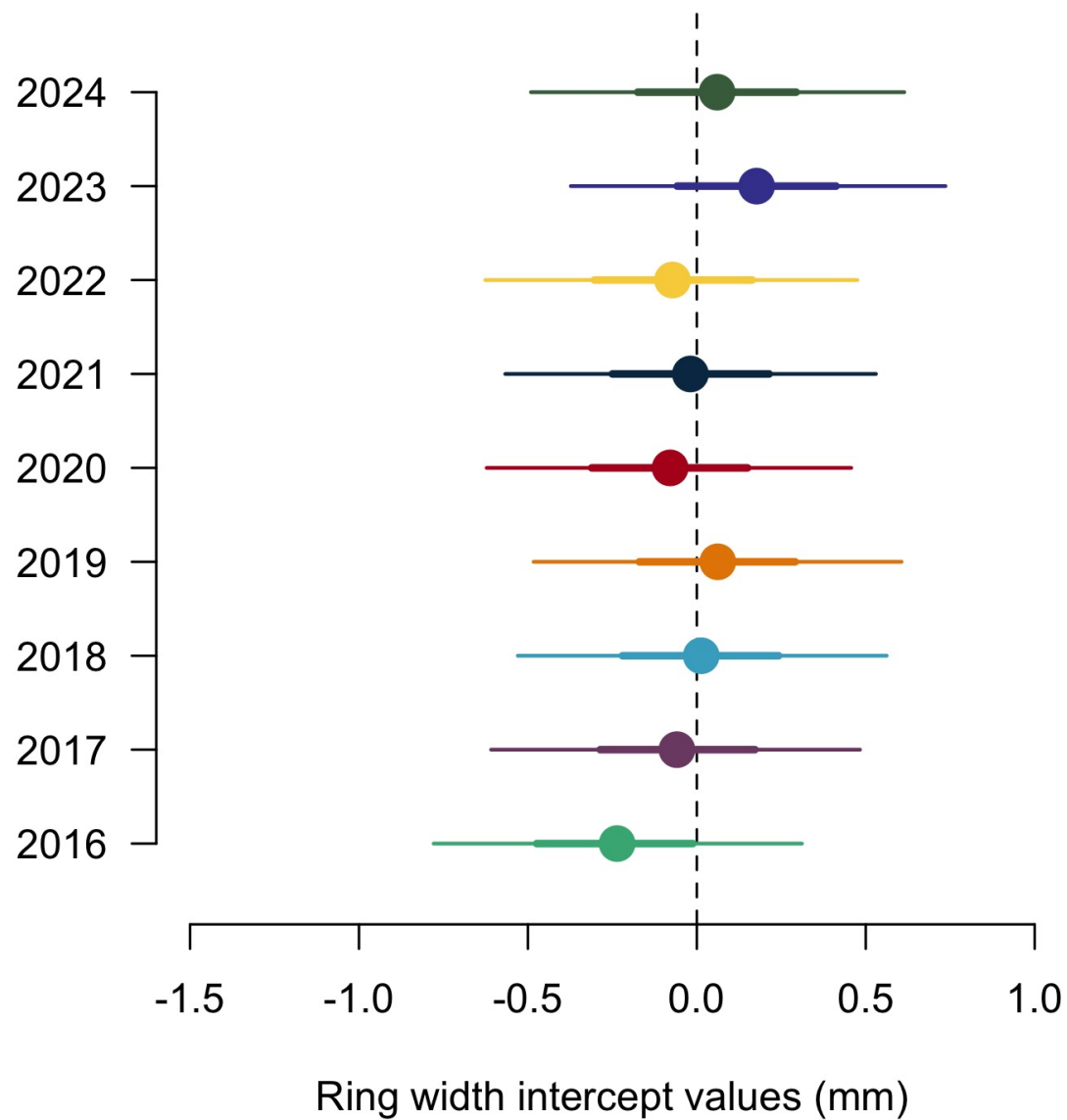


Figure 2: We show tree ring widths (mm) across years as model estimates for the year intercepts with the dots depicting the mean and the lines, the 50% and 90% uncertainty intervals (UI).

Supplemental results

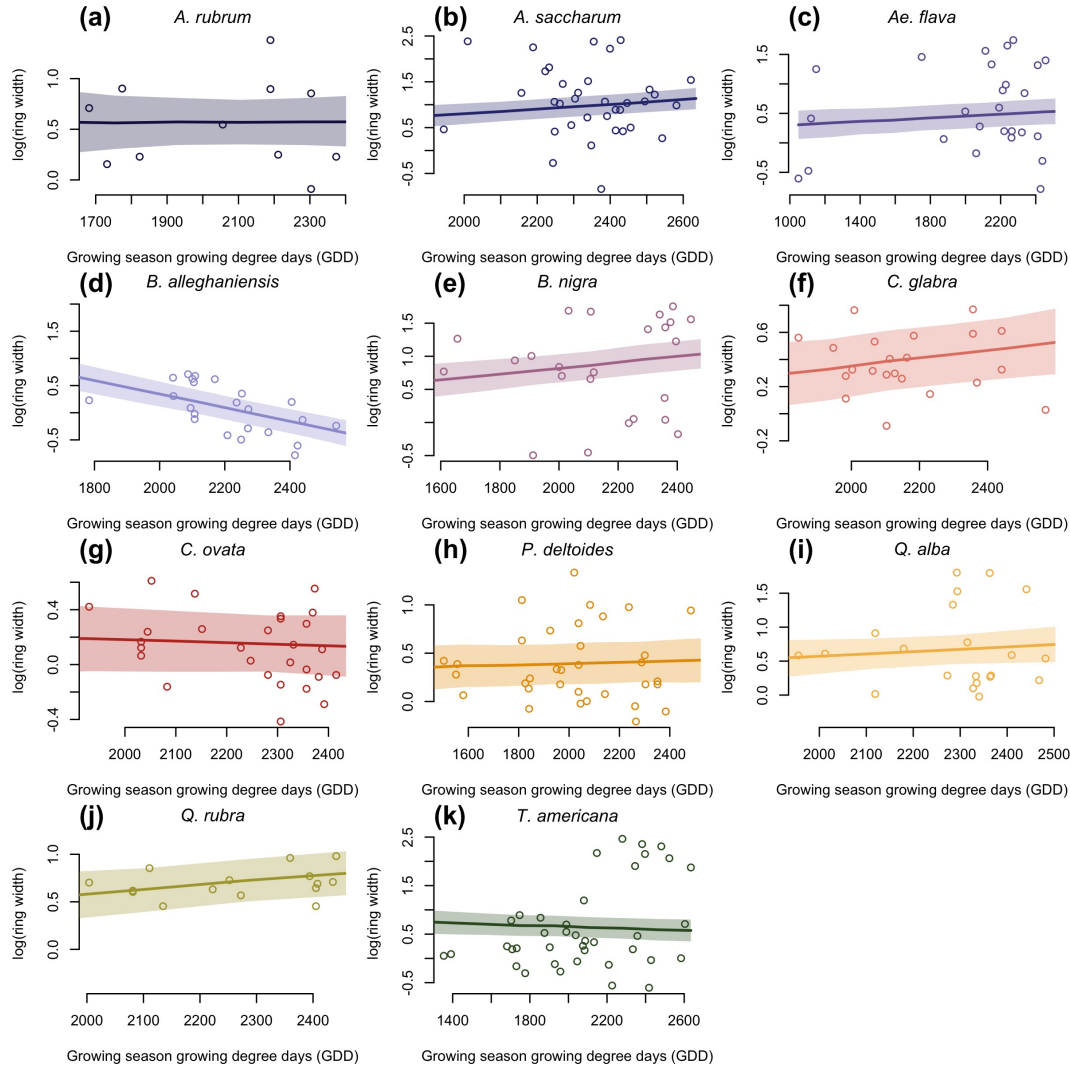


Figure S1: Ring width trends in response to thermal season (GDD). The plots are the reconstructed species estimates posterior distribution with error. The lines represent the mean of the posterior distribution and the shaded area, the 50% UI. The dots are the empirical data shaped by year.

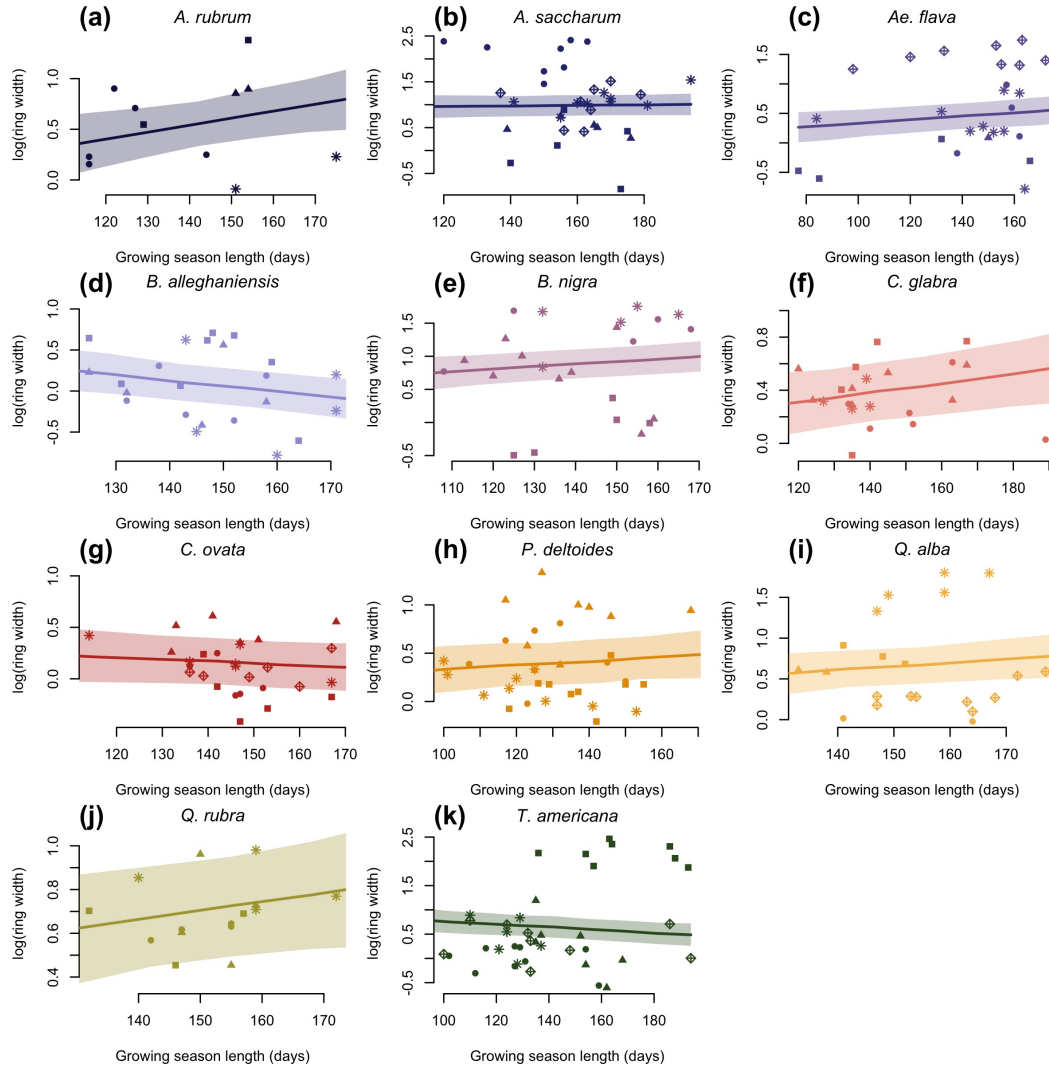


Figure S2: Ring width trends in response to calendar season (GSL). The plots are the reconstructed species estimates posterior distribution with error. The lines represent the mean of the posterior distribution and the shaded area, the 50% UI. The dots are the empirical data shaped by year.

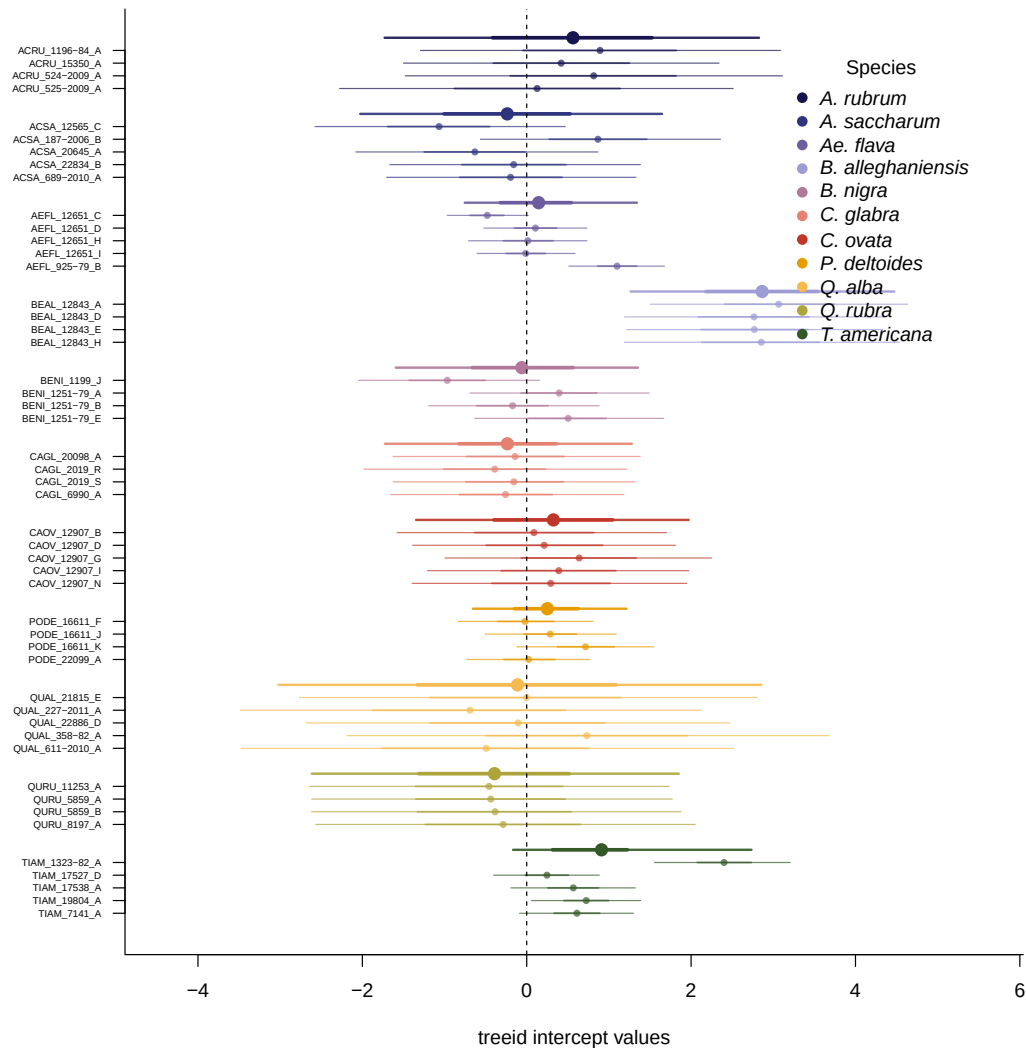


Figure S3: Intercept estimates for each group of the GDD model. The different tree id values represent the sum of the tree id, provenance, species and averaged year intercepts. The larger dots and lines represent aggregated average across these values. The dots are the mean of the posterior distribution and the thick and thin lines, the 50 and 90% UI.